

is to increase the likelihood of factual responses, but some level of uncertainty will always be inherent in generative AI systems.

Q. Why is there a lot of buzz around ‘observability’ in recent times, and how does it relate to Gen AI?

A. Observability is crucial for managing cost, latency, and ensuring responsible AI practices. The cost of language model (LLM) usage can grow exponentially, given the per-token charging model. Therefore, there is a need for a systematic approach to track and observe the incurred costs over time, facilitating optimisation strategies. Latency, especially in certain applications, is a significant factor, as diverse prompting techniques can result in LLM calls taking 1-2 minutes if not optimised. Additionally, considering this technology’s primary USP lies in its creative ability, it is essential to acknowledge that responses generated may not always be truly inclusive or unbiased. All these factors emphasise the importance of observability in the context of Gen AI implementation.

Q. With the growing interest in generative AI, particularly among startups, how does ThoughtWorks plan to engage in this area? Do you intend to collaborate with startups to further expand in this field, considering your focus on community development?

A. There are two aspects to consider here. First, for India to lead in generative AI, we need to focus on supporting Indian languages. Currently, platforms like ChatGPT support several languages but not all Indian ones. Academic institutions like the IITs are investing in creating GPT equivalents for Indian languages, and part of our agenda at ThoughtWorks is to collaborate with these academic researchers. We complement each other’s strengths,

combining their academic prowess with our capability to bring technology to the common people.

For instance, we’ve worked on projects like EkStep, and developed translation models that are now part of *Bhashini*, which was showcased at the G20 summit in 2023 and focuses on translating between Indian languages. Collaborating with academic institutions helps us leverage their resources and expertise, essential for building something as complex and resource-intensive as GPT.

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Another aspect is forming key partnerships with organisations that share our cultural and ethical values. This alignment is crucial for empowering society through technology. While it’s too early to discuss specific partnerships, our goal is to play a more significant role in bringing generative AI to the broader public community. We’re actively seeking partnerships that align with our mission to use technology for societal

benefit, and collaborating with startups is certainly a part of this strategy.

Q. How do you see the level of contribution by Indian techies to open source?

A. Indian techies are doing great. Many start with small ideas and quickly get the necessary funding. One such example is the library Ragas (retrieval augmented generation assessment) by Exploding Gradients. I only wish there are more research contributions from India that we can try out at an early stage for enterprise adoptions.

Q. Do you believe open source will be a crucial factor in making India a technology leader from the grassroots level? How does ThoughtWorks contribute to this vision?

A. I definitely see open source playing a pivotal role in transforming India into a technology leader, especially from the grassroots level. This transformation is already underway. For instance, we are exploring how AI can aid specially-abled people, creating more accessible features in tools like Google Maps, etc.

A noteworthy contribution is the ‘Jugal Bandi’ initiative, presented at the G20 summit. It’s a collaboration with the Indian government to increase awareness of government schemes for farmers. We have developed a bot that communicates in local languages, breaking down barriers in education and technology.

Our ongoing mission is to leverage technology, especially AI, for societal benefit. We aim to empower communities, making technology accessible to the common person and assisting in various aspects of their lives. This approach underlines our commitment to using open source as a tool for societal and technological advancement in India. **END** 🐼